

# OLIVER SIMMONDS

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oliver-simmonds

olisimmonds

## EXPERIENCE

### SSE

#### Data Scientist

September 2024 – Present, (promoted from grad scheme Nov 2025)

- Led development of business-critical **optimisation models** for a **£400 million CAPEX** project, working closely with stakeholders to translate requirements into actionable results.
- Developed and validated **systematic** and **battery trading** strategies, improving statistical rigour and profitability.
- Built **productionised apps**, applying energy market expertise and **CI/CD Azure DevOps** processes to aid energy trading teams.
- Led discovery and integration of LLM models and tools, reducing development time by up to **2.5 hours per developer per day**.
- Implemented AI solutions with HR stakeholders to automate draft responses for **30,000** emails per year, reducing response times by over **90%**.
- Fast-tracked to a permanent Data Scientist role after just **14 months** of the two-year graduate scheme following consistent 'excellent' and 'outstanding' performance reviews.

### Personal & Freelance Projects

#### AI & Data Science Engineer

June 2022 – Present

- Partnered with stakeholders at eco-startup **HyveGeo** to break down and deliver a **research-bot initiative**, building scalable data pipelines and sophisticated ML models to predict biochar properties, packaged as reusable tools.
- Volunteered as the **world's first Digital Ambassador** at **parkrun**, engaging with non-technical staff across the charity to help them generate greater value from its extensive data.
- Led AI strategy of startup **Zéro Mental** by productionising a **RAG chatbot**, building the end-to-end pipeline and **vector database** from thousands of unstructured transcripts.
- Developed an evaluation pipeline for startup **MyTender** to assess AI-generated bids, improving products reliability.
- Co-developed a profit distribution model utilised by **Systema Nova**, one of **Europe's largest angel-based VC** programmes.
- Built a revenue prediction model that achieved a **50%** reduction in error compared to the existing approach for tech company **BigHand**.

### University of Southampton

#### Air Quality Research Analyst

January – August 2024

- Researched PM2.5 patterns in Hampshire, funded by local councils in collaboration with an **associate professor**.
- Presented findings at the **2024 Low Cost AQ Sensor Systems Symposium** and produced a **policy brief** for local government.
- Applied data mining to uncover insights supporting council **air quality improvements**.

## EDUCATION

### University of Southampton

#### MSc in Artificial Intelligence

July 2023 - September 2024

- £4,000 Richard Newitt Postgraduate Taught Bursary for **highest average mark** in the **School of Electronics and Computer Science**
- G-Research award for **highest grade** in Artificial Intelligence
- Distinction award - **80%**
- Dissertation: Evolving Molecular Representations

### University of Bristol

#### BSc in Mathematics

September 2020 - July 2023

- First Class Honours Degree - **81%**
- Co-founder of the **Artificial General Intelligence Safety Group**
- Mathematical Programming tutor
- UoB 5-a-side football Vice President and Captain, competing in **EUSA European Universities Championships, Croatia**
- Award-winning 85%** grade in co-authored research project

### Peter Symonds College

#### A-levels

August 2018 - June 2020

- Mathematics: **A\***, Further Mathematics: **A\***, Physics: **A**, EPQ: **A**

## SKILLS

### +3 Years Experience

Python AI/ML R SQL Power BI

### 1-3 Years Experience

LLMs GenAI Databricks Azure

HTTP REST APIs Async

### Soft Skills

Problem-Solving Collaboration

Stakeholder Engagement Leadership

Proactive Learning